

1 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Which toy disappeared?

What we are practising

Observe a small set and recall a change.

What you need

Large toy car / Soft toy / Large spoon / Towel

Use any three large, clearly different safe objects.

Before you begin

Place the three objects in a row and name them.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Look at the objects together for a few moments.
2. Ask the child to look away while you hide the spoon under the towel.
3. Ask what changed, reveal the spoon, then swap roles.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What was here before but is not here now?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Sort it your way

What we are practising

Group objects using one consistent feature.

What you need

Two soft toys / Two rolled towels / Two large rigid toy blocks

Use large household objects with clearly different textures.

Before you begin

Check that the blocks have smooth edges.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Feel each object and discuss soft and hard.
2. Put the soft items in one group and hard items in another.
3. Mix them again and invite a different rule, such as toys and towels.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can you tell me why this belongs here?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Clap, tap, what comes next?

What we are practising

Notice and continue a two-part repeating sequence.

What you need

No materials

Use two hand gestures silently if preferred.

Before you begin

Choose two comfortable actions, such as clapping and tapping a knee.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Demonstrate clap, tap, clap, tap slowly.
2. Pause after the next clap and ask what comes next.
3. Repeat together, then let the child choose a new two-action pattern.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What little part keeps repeating?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Build a toy road

What we are practising

Try a route, notice a blockage and change the plan.

What you need

Large toy car / Three cushions / Soft toy destination

Move your finger along a drawn road on paper.

Before you begin

Set two cushions as road edges and one as an obstacle on the floor.

Play with hands on the floor; keep the route out of walking paths.

Try it together

1. Place the car at one end and the soft toy at the other.
2. Ask the child to drive without lifting the car over the obstacle.
3. If the route is blocked, move an edge cushion and test again.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Where could the car go around this cushion?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Repair the funny picture

What we are practising

Explain a mismatch using familiar everyday knowledge.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe the funny scene aloud instead of drawing.

Before you begin

Draw a child with shoes on their hands and bare feet.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Look at the picture together without naming the odd detail.
2. Ask what might make getting ready to walk tricky.
3. Let your child draw or describe a change, then invent a new silly scene.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Where would the shoes usually go for a walk?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Which toy disappeared?

A little hint

Recall the object names aloud together.

Answer / what to notice

In the starter round, the spoon is missing.

Comparing the earlier group with the current one reveals the change.

Make it easier

Begin with two objects and leave their positions unchanged.

Take it further

Keep three objects but move one rather than hiding it.

Another day, away from the screen

Notice one change in a familiar room together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Sort it your way

A little hint

Ask whether the new object follows the same rule as its neighbours.

Answer / what to notice

Several groupings work if every object follows the stated rule.

The same objects can form different groups when the rule changes.

Make it easier

Use only two soft objects and two hard blocks.

Take it further

Ask the child to make a group while you guess its rule.

Another day, away from the screen

Sort clean laundry by a child-chosen feature.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Clap, tap, what comes next?

A little hint

Say the pair aloud: clap, tap.

Answer / what to notice

A tap follows the clap in the starter pattern.

Repeating the same pair helps us predict the next action.

Make it easier

Copy one pair at a time with no guessing.

Take it further

Try clap, clap, tap as a three-action unit.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a repeating pattern while walking slowly together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Build a toy road

A little hint

Look for a gap wider than the car.

Answer / what to notice

Any continuous route around the obstacle that fits the car works.

Testing a route shows whether the available space is wide enough.

Make it easier

Leave a clear wide gap to begin.

Take it further

Add a second obstacle and plan before moving.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw the successful route after clearing the floor.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Repair the funny picture

A little hint

Point to the feet and ask what is missing.

Answer / what to notice

For an ordinary walk, shoes usually go on feet; pretend play can use different rules.

Explaining why a detail is unusual is more useful than only calling it wrong.

Make it easier

Offer two choices for where to put the shoes.

Take it further

Draw a scene with two unusual details.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a funny bedtime scene and repair it together.